

Practice question on RNN

1. Consider an encoder-decoder model for sequence to sequence learning as used in tasks like translation. Let $\mathbf{h}_1, \dots, \mathbf{h}_n$ denote encoder states, and $\mathbf{z}_1, \dots, \mathbf{z}_t$ denote the decoder states. Let y_t denote the token output at time t . Provide the equations for computing the distribution over the next token y_{t+1} using the notations below and any intermediate variables that you need:

- $\text{Output}(a, b)$ computes the output vector in terms of input a , b . You need to figure out what a , b should be.
- $\text{Softmax}(o)$ computes softmax using vector o
- $\text{Attn}(a, b)$ denotes the un-normalized attention score in terms of inputs a and b . You need to figure out what a and b should be.
- $E(y)$ returns the embedding vector of a token y
- $\text{D-RNN}(x, z)$ computes the updated decoder state given an input x and current state z .

The first step has been shown for you to give an idea of the format of the answers. Each step is specified as a one line sentence description and a formula.

Step 1

Lookup embedding of token y_t :

$$r = E(y_t)$$

.

Step 2

Step 3

Step 4

Step 5

Step 6

Step 7

2. Consider a seq2seq model using an encoder-decoder network. Suppose, we are considering a setting (example in speech to text) where the attention variables along time need to be monotonic. How can you exploit this information to generate a better attention distribution at t -th decoding step? Assume the encoder RNN states are $\mathbf{h}^i$ for $i = 1, \dots, n$, the decoder RNN states $\mathbf{z}^t$ for $t = 1, \dots, m$. For your reference the standard method of computing attention is

$$\text{Attn}(\mathbf{z}_{t-1}, \mathbf{h}_i) = A_{ti}, \quad \alpha_{ti} = \frac{\exp(A_{ti})}{\sum_p \exp(A_{tp})} \quad (1)$$

where $\alpha_{t1}, \dots, \alpha_{tn}$ denotes the attention over encoder states at time t and sum to 1.

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3. Consider a transformer with the following key, query and value matrices:

$$K = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1.1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$Q = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$V = \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & -0.1 \\ 0.2 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

Calculate the final output of the self attention layer (Take $d_k = 1$) [3 marks] Take $\ln 2$ as 0.7 and $\ln 3$ as 1.1.

$$\text{Output} = \begin{bmatrix} w & x \\ y & z \end{bmatrix}$$

4. In this question, assume that the transformer attention is just $(Q \times K^T)V$, that is the softmax is missing. Let number of heads be one. We use Q, K, V to denote the projected query, key, and value vectors over all inputs of the transformer. The first n inputs to the transformer are n vectors $[\mathbf{x}_i^T, y_i]^T$ where $y_i = \mathbf{w}_\tau \mathbf{x}_i$ where $\mathbf{w}_\tau \in R^d, \mathbf{x} \in R^d$. The last input is $[\mathbf{x}_{n+1}^T, 0]^T$. Assume each $\mathbf{x}_i$ is sampled from a Gaussian distribution $N(0, \sigma^2 I_d)$ where I_d denotes a d dimensional identity matrix. Show the value of the parameters W_k, W_Q, W_v that

can cause the last coordinate of $(Q \times K^T)V$ to match the ordinary least square solution $\mathbf{w}_{\text{OLS}}\mathbf{x}_{n+1}$ where $\mathbf{w}_{\text{OLS}}$ denotes the parameters learned with the first n examples forming the training set. Assume that the training size is large enough so that $X^T X = n\sigma^2 I_d$ where X is a $n \times d$ sized matrix denoting the training dataset. The parameters you specify are only allowed to be a function of n, σ^2 , and not depend on $\mathbf{w}_\tau$.

This example will show that transformers can learn new functions on-the-fly, a capability formally called in-context-learning.

5. Show how you can express the bitwise XOR of n bits using a linear RNN with these equations:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{h}_t &= \text{ReLU}(W\mathbf{h}_{t-1} + Ux_t + \mathbf{b}) \\ o_t &= V\mathbf{h}_t + c\end{aligned}$$

[Hint: Use the solution for representing XOR using feedforward networks]